



**United States Department of the Interior
NATIONAL PARK SERVICE
DENVER SERVICE CENTER
CONTRACTING SERVICES
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**File Code: A14
Sources Sought Notice (SSN)
D5217 (DSC-CS)
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Date: April 15, 2026
To: General Public (Via the Government's Point Entry)
From: Joe Halter, Contracting Officer, National Park Service, Denver Service Center
Subject: Sources Sought Notice (SSN)

Reference: Stabilize Riverbank Along Towpath Trail Near MM 20, Cuyahoga Valley National Park Ohio

**** This is a SSN for the purpose of conducting Market Research. Proposals are NOT being requested, nor accepted at this time. Responses are being requested from both Large and Small Businesses. ****

1. Purpose:

- a. The purpose of this SSN is to gain knowledge regarding the types of interested businesses and their qualifications. Information obtained through this SSN by the NPS will be utilized to develop the acquisition strategy. The amount of interest, or lack thereof, will determine the possibility of a Small Business or other Socio-Economic Set-Aside for solicitation and award purposes. Analysis of the quality of responses to this SSN will be considered in the Market Research being conducted and in the making of any set-aside determination for this requirement.;
- b. The Government anticipates conducting a competitive acquisition for this requirement. The amount of interest or lack thereof will determine the possibility of a small business or other socio-economical small business set-aside for the solicitation. Analysis of the quality of responses to this source sought announcement will be considered in the market research being conducted, and in the making of any small business set-aside determination for this requirement; and
- c. No solicitation, proposal package, specifications, or drawings are available with this SSN.

2. Cost Reimbursement: Response to this announcement is strictly voluntary. No reimbursement will be made for any costs associated with providing information in response to this SSN, nor any follow-up information requests.

3. Bonding: Bid, Performance, and Payment Bonds are anticipated to be required.

4. North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) code: 237990 and Size Standard: \$39.5M

5. Project Description: The project is located at Cuyahoga Valley National Park at Eight Select Sites, Ohio.

The construction magnitude is Between \$1,000,000 and \$5,000,000

The surrounding areas include rural, urban, industrial and residential with limited staging areas.

The Park will remain open during construction, thus contract activities and logistics must be structured and scheduled to minimize visitor impact. The site requires protective measures to ensure the surrounding area remains undisturbed. The anticipated period of performance of 250 calendar days including any potential weather shutdown. There are seasonal/other shutdowns mandated through the construction season.

Project Scope: The Cuyahoga Valley is an important asset to the National Park Service in the Park, south of the Cleveland metropolitan area. The Park includes an historic railroad, known as the Valley Railway, which runs primarily along the left (west) bank of the Cuyahoga River. Along the right (east) bank of the river is another historic asset – the Ohio & Erie Canal and Towpath Trail which was built in the early 1800s to connect Lake Erie to the Ohio River. The Park is very popular with the public, and the National Register Towpath Trail and Scenic Railroad are heavily used by Park visitors daily.

The MM 20 site along the Towpath Trail is a high-priority site that is at risk of failure due to riverbank erosion caused by frequent flooding and high-water events. Riverbank failure would significantly damage the cultural resources and make the path unusable for a significant period of time. Loss of the assets would be detrimental to the Park and its programs. At this location, the Cuyahoga riverbank will be repaired, reconstructed, and stabilized to address the erosion problems that threaten extensive damage to the historic resources. The proposed remediation will provide a level of protection for these historic resources.

The ongoing river erosion processes are influenced by both natural and manmade causes. Development influences the volume and timing of runoff to the river and influences the river's planform where embankments, bridges, and other features have been constructed in the river corridor. In the Midwest, the increase in intensity and frequency of rainfall-runoff events has been associated with climate change. These influences coupled with natural geomorphological process have resulted in appreciable meandering at sites such as Towpath MM 20 South.

This project site requires attention due to the over-steepening of banks that introduces safety concerns for Towpath Trail use. The loss of soil material along the bank has resulted in drop-offs within just a few feet from the trail's edge. It has required repeated temporary closures and emergency repairs to address failed trail sections.

6. **Solicitation:** At this time, NPS DSC anticipates issuing a competitive Request for Proposals (RFP) around the June 2026; and awarding a single Firm-Fixed-Price (FFP) contract.
7. **Submittal Instructions:** Responses shall be captured by filling out (in its entirety) the attached Sources Sought Survey Questionnaire. The interested Contractor shall respond no later than 11:00 AM Mountain Time (MT) on May 11, 2026 by emailing the questionnaire to the Contract Specialist at: brian_baugh@contractor.nps.gov and Contracting Officer at : joseph_halter@ios.doi.gov.

Attachment: Sources Sought Questionnaire Attachment 1

Revisions

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